
Q3 2026 Regional Performance Review

JD Sports UK | August to October 2026 (Periods 7-9)

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1. Executive Summary

JD Sports UK achieved total revenue of GBP 1.36 billion in Q3, representing 103.8% of the GBP 1.31 billion plan and growth of 4.2% versus the prior year quarter.

Like-for-like sales growth was 3.2%, driven by strong performance in the Back to School campaign in August and continued momentum in the running footwear category. Gross margin was 47.2%, 0.6 percentage points below the plan of 47.8%, primarily due to higher-than-planned markdown activity on apparel and a mix shift towards lower-margin footwear.

Online revenue was GBP 435 million, or 32.0% of total revenue, in line with the full-year target. Online conversion improved to 5.1%, up from 4.8% in the prior year quarter. Operating profit for the quarter was GBP 133 million, representing a 9.8% margin, in line with the full-year target.

Total Revenue: GBP 1,360 million
(103.8% of plan)

Like-for-Like Growth: +3.2%

Gross Margin: 47.2% (0.6pp below plan)

Online Revenue: GBP 435 million
(32.0%)

Online Conversion: 5.1%

Operating Profit: GBP 133 million
(9.8% margin)

2. Revenue by Period

Period 7 (August) achieved GBP 480 million, driven by the Back to School campaign which hit 102% of its GBP 470 million revenue target. The campaign benefited from strong sell-through of Nike Air Force 1, Adidas Gazelle, and the 3 for 2 accessories promotion.

Period 8 (September) achieved GBP 440 million, in line with plan. The month performed well in footwear but saw softer apparel sales as the transition from summer to autumn ranges created a gap in outerwear availability.

Period 9 (October) achieved GBP 440 million against a plan of GBP 430 million. Performance was boosted by early cold weather driving demand for The North Face outerwear and autumn footwear styles.

3. Regional Performance

Regional performance was mixed, with six regions above plan and five below plan.

North West (105.2% of plan)

Total revenue was GBP 190 million against a plan of GBP 181 million. Like-for-like sales grew 4.8%. The Manchester Arndale flagship was the standout store at 108% of plan, driven by strong Nike and Adidas performance.

London and South East (104.1% of plan)

Combined revenue of GBP 408 million. The Westfield London and Westfield Stratford stores both exceeded plan

by 6% or more. However, several smaller high street stores in outer London boroughs were below plan, reflecting the ongoing shift of footfall towards large shopping centres.

Scotland (92.5% of plan - UNDERPERFORMER)

Total revenue was GBP 128 million against a plan of GBP 138 million, a GBP 10 million shortfall. Like-for-like sales declined by 1.2%. Two factors drove the underperformance. The Dundee and Inverness stores were affected by planned refurbishment closures, reducing capacity by a combined 6 trading weeks. Separately, stock allocation for the Back to School campaign was misaligned with Scottish demand patterns, with an undersupply of larger shoe sizes which sell disproportionately strongly in Scotland. The Glasgow Buchanan Street flagship performed well at 103% of plan, partially offsetting the weakness.

Other Regions

The Midlands achieved 102.4% of plan with the Birmingham Bullring flagship at 106% of plan. The South West achieved 101.5% of plan, driven by the Bristol Cabot Circus store. Yorkshire and the North East together achieved 101.8% of plan with Leeds Trinity and Newcastle Eldon Square both exceeding plan by 4% or more. Wales achieved 100.5% of plan. Northern Ireland achieved 99.0% of plan.

4. Channel Performance

Store revenue was GBP 925 million, representing 68.0% of total quarterly revenue and growth of 2.8% versus the prior year. Like-for-like store sales grew 2.1%. Footfall across the estate was up 3.5% versus the prior year, with average transaction value increasing from GBP 72.00 to GBP 74.50.

Online revenue was GBP 435 million, representing 32.0% of total quarterly revenue and growth of 7.5% versus the prior year. Average order value was GBP 84.50, up from GBP 82.00. Click and collect accounted for 24% of online orders.

5. Category Performance

Footwear revenue was GBP 748 million (55.0% of total), growing 4.8% versus prior year. Gross margin was 44.5%. The running footwear subcategory grew 14% year on year, driven by ASICS Gel Kayano 31, Hoka Clifton 9, and Nike Pegasus 41.

Apparel revenue was GBP 517 million (38.0% of total), growing 3.2% versus prior year. Gross margin was 49.0%, 1.0 percentage point below plan due to higher markdown activity on summer clearance lines. Own-brand apparel performed well with sell-through rates of 78%.

Accessories revenue was GBP 95 million (7.0% of total), growing 2.5% versus prior year. Gross margin was 51.5%, in line with plan.

6. Brand Performance

Nike revenue was GBP 544 million (40.0% of total), growing 3.5% versus prior year. Gross margin was 46.8%. Lifestyle product sold well with sell-through rates above 80%. Running product was more challenging with higher-than-planned promotional activity on the Pegasus 41.

Adidas revenue was GBP 354 million (26.0% of total), growing 4.0% versus prior year. Gross margin was 47.5%.

The Gazelle and Samba franchises continued to perform strongly with sell-through rates above 85%.

New Balance revenue was GBP 82 million (6.0% of total), growing 18.0% versus prior year. Gross margin was 48.0%. The North Face revenue was GBP 68 million (5.0% of total), growing 6.5% versus prior year. Own-brand revenue was GBP 109 million (8.0% of total), growing 12.0% with gross margin of 55.0%.

7. Top 10 Products

1. Nike Air Force 1 Low: GBP 54.0 million (540,000 pairs). 2. Adidas Gazelle: GBP 42.0 million (494,000 pairs). 3. Nike Dunk Low: GBP 39.0 million (371,000 pairs). 4. The North Face Nuptse Jacket: GBP 30.0 million (113,000 units). 5. Nike Tech Fleece Hoodie: GBP 26.0 million (217,000 units). 6. Adidas Samba: GBP 24.0 million (282,000 pairs). 7. Nike Air Max 90: GBP 23.0 million (177,000 pairs). 8. Converse Chuck Taylor: GBP 19.0 million (317,000 pairs). 9. Vans Old Skool: GBP 16.5 million (254,000 pairs). 10. New Balance 530: GBP 15.0 million (176,000 pairs, up 45% YoY).

8. Operational Metrics

Average transaction value in stores was GBP 74.50 (plan GBP 73.00). Online average order value was GBP 84.50 (plan GBP 83.00). Units per transaction was 1.9 in stores and 1.7 online.

The return rate was 22.8% overall. Online returns were 28.5%, primarily driven by footwear fit issues. In-store returns were 4.5%.

Stock at quarter end was GBP 1.28 billion at retail value, representing 9.2 weeks of cover against a target of 8.5 weeks. Aged stock over 90 days represented 9.5% of total stock value, above the target of 8.0%.

9. Key Issues and Corrective Actions

Three issues require management attention in Q4. First, the Scotland underperformance with a GBP 10 million revenue gap versus plan requires expedited store refurbishments, rebalanced size curves for larger sizes, and a dedicated regional marketing campaign.

Second, approximately GBP 45 million of summer seasonal apparel is aged over 90 days. A targeted markdown campaign with 40% to 50% discount is recommended for December, with an expected margin impact of GBP 2 million to GBP 3 million.

Third, the Nike aged stock position at GBP 18.5 million (11.5% of total Nike stock) requires a coordinated markdown plan under the framework agreement's markdown support provisions.

10. Outlook for Q4

Q4 is the most important quarter of the financial year, with a target of GBP 1.64 billion in revenue. November is driven by Black Friday at GBP 560 million. December is the peak Christmas trading month at GBP 770 million. The Scotland recovery plan, aged stock clearance programme, and continued investment in the running footwear category are the three key priorities for the quarter.

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